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Christ Episcopal Church
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Special Announcement
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DISCIPLES MAKING DISCIPLES FOR JESUS CHRIST:
By Encountering God, Equipping God's People, and Extending
God's Kingdom



Welcome, Pastor Jill Williams!

Dear Christ Church Family,

Our parish has traditionally had an Assistant Priest to help with our large parish. Often she or he has been a Curate, meaning the first “cure of souls” for someone recently graduated from seminary and newly ordained. The last few include Shelley White, Beth Rauen-Sciano and Liz Costello. Christ Church has had many notable Curates over the decades, who were very effective at Christ Church during their ministry AND the wider Church after leaving Christ Church, such as Diocese of N.H.’s retired Bishop, Gene Robinson (at CC from 1973-1975), former Dean of the Cathedral in Cleveland Tracey Lind (at CC 1986-1989), and Bonnie Perry, the new Bishop of Michigan (at CC from 1989-1991)!

One of our goals the past couple of years has been to bring back our Curate, which is a vital component for a parish our size. We described this at last year’s Annual Meeting, when the Vestry discussed and then budgeted to add back a Curate, effective August 2019. This is in addition to Fr. Bill, who continues thankfully as the Assistant to the Rector for Adult Formation. Our timeline was pushed out somewhat in order to find the right candidate and then to wait on a timeline that worked for all.

On behalf of the Wardens, Vestry and Christ Church family, I’m happy to announce that Christ Church has found our new Curate, and her name is **Jill Williams**! Her intro can be found below. This is all fairly new for her, but she would like to be referred to as either Pastor Jill or Jill. She is beginning her ministry with Christ Church formally on February 1, 2020, but is moving this week to start to get settled. She will also be part of the deputation representing Christ Church at this year’s Diocesan Convention.

We had decided to call Pastor Jill back in late November, after six members of Vestry and related ministries and I met with potential candidates. After the prayerful decision, it took time for her to complete her final semester at Virginia Theological Seminary and to complete the General Ordination Exams. It also took time for our Bishop’s staff to look over the necessary documents. Until those were all done, we were asked not to make a formal announcement. We’re pleased that those milestones have now been met, and we are delighted to finally be able to make this announcement and formally welcome Jill and her wife, Paula!

As part of the preparation, we have readied a large part of the Cottage with some refurbishments over the past couple of months. It is wonderful to be able to house our Curate by realigning the use of the Cottage, and it is a very nice home for them plus their furry friends (and shelled

it is a very nice home for them, plus their hairy friends (and crabs)!

This is truly a **wonderful** moment for us to share as a parish. Having Jill join us helps to put us on a path to living more fully into our mission and will inevitably help to extend and expand our ministries. But, most important of all, it makes us stronger as a parish that is committed to our primary Mission Statement of "Disciples making Disciples." May God bless us all in our shared ministry in Christ's name, at Christ Church!

In Christ,
Fr. Tom

Hello sisters and brothers of Christ Church!

My name is Jill+ and I am the new Curate! I am looking forward to getting to know all of you and becoming part of your church family. My wife, Paula, and I will be arriving in Ridgewood this week. We have been married for 23 years and have one daughter, Cammy, who is now 22 and making her own way in the world. Paula and I were both born and raised in Baltimore, Maryland, so this move to Ridgewood is the first time we will live anywhere else. We will live in The Cottage with our dog, Simba, our very senior cat, Maggie, and 2 hermit crabs. Paula and I enjoy spending our time together doing anything creative or being in nature, and we are super excited about exploring a whole new state!

This has been quite a time of transition. In November I was ordained as a Transitional Deacon (later this spring will be my ordination to the priesthood). I also completed a Masters of Divinity at Virginia Theological Seminary in December. And this other wonderful thing happened! I felt a clear call to serve at Christ Church. What a blessed experience it was to learn of this parish and to know that God was making a way for me to become part of the ministry here.

In my role as Curate, I will be doing so many things that I love – liturgy, preaching, teaching, outreach, learning, and the countless other things that I am so excited to do with you. But here's the best part of all of it, here's the most life-giving thing about being a minister to me: being present with you. That means during services, activities, and joyous celebrations of fellowship, yes, but it also means being there through sickness and death and trouble and all the hard stuff of life. All these moments are sacred and it will be my privilege to walk in faith with you

.. . .

through them.

I am so absolutely happy to be at Christ Church and I look forward to many years of serving our Amazing God here with you all! Please introduce yourself to me when you see me; I can't wait to meet you!

Jill+

This February and March, in addition to meeting Jill at worship services, we will have multiple opportunities for parishioners to get to know her better, including:

- during the coffee hours on Sunday, Feb. 2
- at the Newcomers' Reception on Sunday, Feb. 9
- at the Progressive Dinner on Saturday, March 14 (so get those RSVP's in soon!)
- at the Adult Forum on February 16th with a Meet and Greet and Q&A

Just as important is the opportunity for Pastor Jill to get to know you all!

As part of an effort to acclimate Jill and Paula to the Ridgewood area, please share with them your favorite local eateries and activities. You may email them at jwilliams@christchurchridgewood.org, or send them to communications@christchurchridgewood.org and Patty will compile them and send them along.

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